



REVENGE AND FORGIVENESS



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:

1I3M-N1L6-C76



1

Warm up

In pairs, discuss the following questions.

1. Are there any well-known stories of revenge in your country? If so, what are they?
2. What do you think the benefits may be of forgiving someone for doing something against you?
3. What do people from your culture generally think about the concepts of revenge and forgiveness?





2

Focus on vocabulary

Complete the definitions with the given words.

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1. **grudge (n)** - a feeling of _____ or upset at what someone has done to you in the past
2. **stipulate (v)** - make it clear _____ how something must be done or what needs to be done
3. **convene (v)** - _____ for two or more people to come together for an activity or formal meeting
4. **dispossess (v)** - take away someone's _____, land or house
5. **inundate (v)** - create so many things that it is difficult to keep _____ of all of them
6. **vendetta (n)** - a long-standing and bitter feud, especially one involving _____
7. **morph (v)** - _____ from one thing to another
8. **delusional (adj.)** - having beliefs or _____ that do not resemble reality
9. **relitigate (v)** - argue about if something was true or _____ again and again

3

Understanding the video: part 1

You are going to watch the video titled "The true story behind the legend of the 47 ronin". Watch Part 1 (00:00-01:48) and answer the following questions.



1. Who was the original disagreement between?
2. When did the fight take place?
3. What is 'Edo' now called?
4. What did the government do to threaten the role of samurais?
5. Why were some samurai not happy about the government's decision following the disagreement?
6. What happened to Asano?
7. What does 'ronin' mean?



4

Understanding video: part 2

Watch Part 2 (01:48-05:19) and choose the correct answer A-C for the following.



1. What is thought to be the cause of the disagreement between the two masters?
 - a. a display of disrespect
 - b. lack of payment
 - c. an unknown reason
2. What was the paradox faced by the samurai?
 - a. They were famed for their fighting skills, but banned from using them.
 - b. They weren't allowed to work, but honour meant they couldn't steal.
 - c. They could only make money by committing suicide.
3. Whose advice did the remaining samurai follow after their master's death?
 - a. Horibe Yasubei
 - b. Oishi Yoshio
 - c. Asano's brother
4. What problem did the government's resolution cause for the samurai?
 - a. Their leadership wasn't replaced in the way they expected.
 - b. They were forced to accept a leader they didn't respect.
 - c. They were given government roles that they didn't want.
5. What issue did the 47 samurai create for the government?
 - a. They had acted against the law, but according to samurai code.
 - b. Their actions had been legal, but horrified the general public.
 - c. They feared the samurai would attack them if they tried to arrest them.
6. Why did the story of the 47 samurai capture the public's imagination?
 - a. Their fighting skills were widely feared.
 - b. Their honourable actions were greatly admired.
 - c. Their actions were both praised and criticised.



5

Reading for gist

You are going to read an article titled "Forgive and forget?" Choose the correct word A-C to complete gaps 1-8 in the text.

Forgive and forget?

A) When we forgive someone who we feel has hurt us in some way, there are a range of positive effects for both parties. Studies have shown the act to _____¹ the risk of mental illness and heart disease. In addition, there's an increase in happiness, health and a likelihood that you'll be more financially productive. It doesn't even _____² an apology from the transgressor in advance for the wronged party to benefit. Not bad for three little words: I forgive you.

B) The concept of forgiving someone is found around the world, though how it is _____³ in cultures can vary. Broadly speaking, cultures can be divided into two groups: those which focus on the individual and those which focus on the group. In African and Asian cultures, forgiving someone can be done because it will help the society in which the person exists whereas in Western cultures such as the UK and the US, it is more _____⁴ that it will be so that the person feels better about themselves or wants to draw a line under an ongoing issue that irks them.

C) However, the language of the particular culture also plays a part in the understanding of forgiveness. For example, the Tahitian word "pe'ape'a" _____⁵ to a range of negative sensations such as feeling ill, tired or unenthusiastic. Where in English we might say that a conflict with another makes us feel sad, Tahitians are more likely to say it makes them feel sick, possibly even feeling physical symptoms that go with it. For Zulus in South Africa, the term 'ubuntu' would be used in the case of forgiving someone, but it more _____⁶ translates as 'showing humanity towards others', an altogether more significant act. In Sierra Leone, 'fambul tok' translates directly as 'family talk', indicating that forgiving someone is close to mending a relationship with relatives. These varied expressions show the high level of regard that forgiving someone can be held in.

D) As humans, we find it difficult to say one thing while believing or accepting another and it _____⁷ us psychological distress. This is known as 'cognitive dissonance'. To say that you no longer have a grudge against someone is uncomfortable if it's not truly felt. As a result, our actions can often follow our words as we try to align them. So saying that you forgive someone can often be the first _____⁸ to actually feeling it. The same is true of expressing regret or sorrow over your actions. So instead of going off on one, bring a little happiness and peace into your life and try to forgive, apologise and forget.

Sources: BBC, The Japan Times



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|----------------|------------|--------------|
| 1. a. less | b. smaller | c. lower |
| 2. a. require | b. offer | c. owe |
| 3. a. watched | b. done | c. viewed |
| 4. a. recently | b. likely | c. possibly |
| 5. a. seeks | b. applies | c. requests |
| 6. a. closely | b. nearly | c. carefully |
| 7. a. causes | b. makes | c. creates |
| 8. a. step | b. stair | c. foot |

6

Scanning for vocabulary

Find vocabulary in the article that means the same as the following definitions.

1. _____ (adj., para. A): achieving a great deal
2. _____ (n, para. A): a person who does something morally or legally wrong
3. _____ (adv., para. B): in a very general way
4. _____ (v, para. B): irritate or annoy
5. _____ (n, para. C): people in general
6. _____ (n, para. C): repairing something so that it works
7. _____ (n, para. D): a situation where you have thoughts or beliefs that do not match what you say or evidence you are shown
8. _____ (n, para. D): a feeling of being very sad due to something very bad that has happened



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7

Reading comprehension

Part A: Decide if the following statements are true, false or not given.

1. The willingness to forgive someone can mean making more money later in some cases. _____
2. You can only really benefit from forgiving someone if the person who has wronged you shows that they are sorry first. _____
3. Africans and Asians are more likely to forgive someone to benefit themselves. _____
4. Tahitians have fewer incidents of mental illness than in the West due to how they deal with negative emotions. _____
5. People in Sierra Leone will only forgive someone they are related to. _____
6. Calling yourself an 'animal lover' while eating meat and wearing leather is an example of cognitive dissonance. _____
7. Feeling as though you will never be forgiven for the negative treatment of others is a major cause of mental illness. _____

Part B: Answer the following questions in your own words.

1. What is the meaning of '*draw a line under...*' in paragraph B?
2. What is the meaning of '*going off on one*' in paragraph D?

8

Talking point

In pairs, discuss the following questions.

1. Do you think forgiveness is always possible? Why/Why not?
2. Do you think revenge can ever be a positive act? Why/Why not?
3. Why do you think films about revenge such as Kill Bill, John Wick, and Gladiator are so popular?
4. Many countries have the death penalty for the most serious crimes. Do you think that this can be justified in some cases? Why/Why not?
5. Have there been situations in your life when you have forgiven someone? What was it for and what was the result?
6. In what situations have you held a grudge against someone? What did they do? How was it resolved?



9

Extended activity / homework

Read the question. To what extent do you agree with the given statement? You should write at least 250 words and check your spelling, grammar and punctuation.

Incidents of revenge only occur when the law fails to protect or avenge ordinary people. If the law functions as it should, there should be no cause for taking revenge.

